

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's come up with a solution!



Learning Outcome

Present advice on solving technical problems in a work context and appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- What do you do when you have a problem at work or at school?
- How do you solve the problem? Do you ask for advice or suggestions from other people?

Can Do Statements

- I can come up with solutions to support the team.
- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can talk about things happening right now.





Let's Explore!

This training should have many **returns***!

* "Returns" are profits or good results which come back to a person after investing time, money or effort.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Miranda:** Today we're discussing our research strategy for South America. How do we establish realistic goals to meet our communications objectives?
- Ferdinand:** By targeting the appropriate audiences and the right influencers.
- Miranda:** How do we determine that from here?
- Ferdinand:** We might obtain a lot from online surveys but I usually rely heavily on field surveys.
- Miranda:** I greatly benefit from focus group studies.
- Ferdinand:** Impossible to organize from here.
- Miranda:** Any suggestions?
- Rocco:** It might be worth the investment sending Ferdinand on a trip to prepare the ground, do some research, build new connections ... what's going on politically in Colombia now?
- Ferdinand:** Ah, the timing is perfect because the president is visiting Bogota to discuss the trade this month.
- Miranda:** Rocco, I'm in agreement if you are convinced of the returns.
- Rocco:** Jetlines are competing fiercely at the moment. We might be better off having Ferdinand take a multiple destination flight. That way, it might be possible to do a comparative study.
- Ferdinand:** What are you thinking ... ?
- Rocco:** Well, I know your family is living in Brazil now. You could make connections in Sao Paulo. We can't assume Colombian and Brazilian markets are uniform.
- Ferdinand:** You're absolutely right.
- Miranda:** What's currently happening in Brazil?
- Ferdinand:** The federal election happened last month so people are no longer thinking about politics.
- Miranda:** Sounds good. Let's approach Janet.





Let's Practice!

What are they talking about at the meeting?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Write the missing verbs. Choose from these verbs: happening, thinking, discussing, living, competing, going, visiting. Say the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Today we're _____ our research strategy for South America.
2. What's _____ on politically in Colombia now?
3. The president is _____ Bogotá to discuss trade this month.
4. Jetlines are _____ fiercely at the moment.
5. I know your family is _____ in Brazil now.
6. What's currently _____ in Brazil?
7. The federal election happened last month so people are no longer _____ about politics.

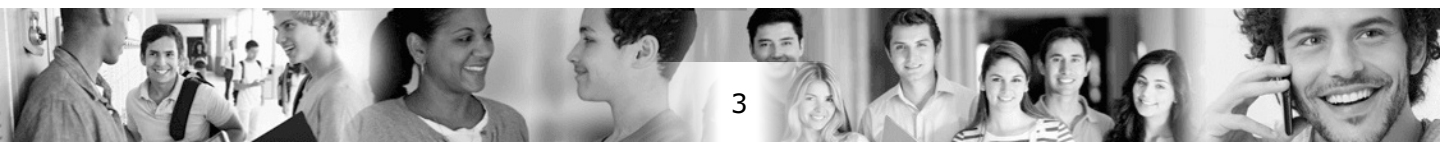
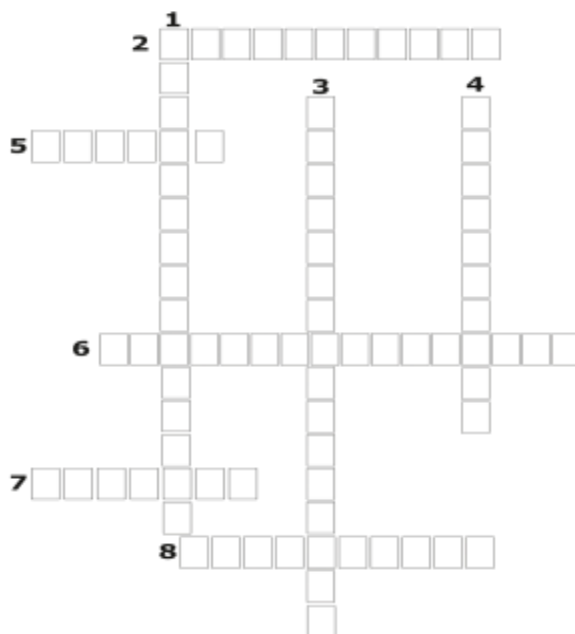


Let's Practice!

There are a lot of important words being thrown around at the meeting. What are they?

Instructions: Complete the crossword. First, read the clues. Then, write your answer.

1. A political event during which the leader and party are chosen to lead the country, usually through public votes
2. A set of questions to ask a large group of people in a particular area
3. Research that compares and contrasts two or more focus areas
4. A small group of people who are interviewed or studied together by a company or researcher
5. To focus or make contact with
6. Doing the tasks necessary to get ready for the main work
7. Standard; having the same or even results
8. A person who can affect opinions or decision making





Extension Activity

Let's solve some issues in your homeland!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of two issues that are currently happening in your country or workplace.
- Write a dialogue of 10-12 lines.
- In the dialogue, make sure you describe the problems and come up with solutions to deal with the problems.
- When you are finished, proofread the dialogue and read it aloud with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I identify current, local issues.

☐ ☐

I come up with solutions to deal with problems.

☐ ☐

I read my solutions to problems aloud to another person.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to target** (verb): to focus or make contact with
e.g. We meet our communication objectives by targeting the appropriate audience.
- **influencer** (noun): a person who can affect opinions or decision-making
e.g. Knowing the right influencers can help us meet our communication objectives.
- **field survey** (noun): a set of questions to ask a large group of people in a particular area
e.g. I usually rely heavily on field surveys for my research.
- **focus group** (noun): a small group of people who are interviewed or studied together by a company or researcher
e.g. I greatly benefit from focus group studies.
- **prepare the ground** (expression): doing the tasks necessary to get ready for the main work
e.g. It might be worthwhile to send Ferdinand on a trip to prepare the ground.
- **comparative study** (noun): research that compares and contrasts two or more focus areas
e.g. It might be possible to do a comparative study.
- **uniform** (adjective): standard, having the same or even results
e.g. We can't assume Colombian and Brazilian markets are uniform.
- **federal election** (noun): a political event during which the leader and party are chosen to lead the country, usually through public votes
e.g. The federal election happened last month so people are no longer thinking about it.





Learning Points

Present Continuous

The **Present Continuous** tense is normally used to talk about an action happening in the present or at the moment.

However, it can also be used to indicate future. It expresses the idea that something will (or will not) happen in the future.

The future can be noticed through the use of a future word.

The **Present Continuous** tense is formed by *be* and the present participle (*-ing*) of a verb.

Affirmative	<i>I</i> <i>He / She / It</i> <i>You / We /</i> <i>They</i>	<i>'m / am</i> <i>'s / is</i> <i>'re / are</i>	<i>discussing our strategy</i> <i>today.</i>
Interrogative	<i>Am</i> <i>Is</i> <i>Are</i>	<i>I</i> <i>he / she / it</i> <i>you / we /</i> <i>they</i>	<i>discussing our strategy</i> <i>today?</i>

Using the Present Continuous

- You can use it to describe actions, situations or things that are in progress at the moment of speaking.

*Today, we're **discussing** our main strategy for the European market.*

- The Present Continuous is also used to describe actions or situations that are in progress around the present, but not necessarily at the moment of speaking.

*The politician **is visiting** Toronto to discuss elections.*

- When describing changes and trends you can also the **Present Continuous**.

*People **are not thinking** about elections.*

*The companies **are competing** fiercely.*





Learning Points

Making Suggestions and Giving Advice

Sometimes you have an idea, a recommendation or plan that you think could work for your company. It is important to use proper language to offer those ideas for someone to consider. Here is some language you can use for making suggestions and giving advice.

1. You can use *How do/does* + subject + verb and *should ...* + verb to ask for suggestions or advice.

How do we ensure that our goals meet their objectives?

Should we send one of our staff there to establish new connections?

1. You can make suggestions and give advice using the preposition *by* + *-ing*

By focusing on the approaches that have worked for us so far.

1. If you want your suggestion/advice to sound polite, you use *might* + verb, *might like/want* + *to* + verb or *might be better off* + *-ing*.

It might be worth sending one of our staff there to prepare the ground.

We ***might be better off sending*** one of our staff there to do some research.

It ***might be*** possible to send one of our staff there to build connections.

1. If you want to make the suggestion/advice less direct, you use *could*.

You ***could make*** a stop in Sao Paulo on your way there.

